

Business challenge: Anthony's email

In this activity, apply what you've learned about Gmail to help Anthony Dylan at On the Rise solve a business challenge.

* During this activity, you use your Gmail as if it were Anthony's account.

Task 1

You tell Anthony that his goals are easily accomplished using Gmail and that you're happy to help. You promise to set up his account to simplify his workload. As you begin collaborating, you immediately notice that Anthony has not updated his signature block. You offer to help. Create a new signature block for Anthony using the following information and formatting style. Once you're done, name the signature block "On the Rise." Make sure you save your changes.

DO:

1. In your Gmail settings, create a new signature.
2. Add and format the text:

Anthony Dylan
Product Distribution & Operations
On the Rise
616-555-5555 (w)
616-777-7777 (m)

3. Name the signature block "On the Rise."
4. Remember to save your changes.



Task 2

Anthony thanks you for updating his signature block. He now tells you he needs help managing his contacts. He explains that his intention is to send the survey to a group of external vendors and suppliers every month. He is concerned it is very time consuming if he has to type each email each time.

You tell Anthony all he needs to do is create a contact label and assign emails of the vendors and suppliers. Contact labels make bulk email a quicker process in the future. Help him create a contact label now. Create a contact label named “On the Rise Vendors and Suppliers” and add the suppliers and vendors you have been provided.

Complete the following steps:

1. From your Contacts, create a label named “On the Rise Vendors and Suppliers.”
2. Add some colleagues to the label.

Task 3

As Anthony is sending a similar email each month, you suggest creating a template that he can reuse. Anthony gives you the language he wants to include.

Help Anthony by building and enabling templates in Gmail. Next, build a template based on the information he provided. Name the template “OTR Monthly Survey” and save it. Be sure to include Anthony’s new signature line!

Complete the following steps:

1. Make sure you have enabled templates in Gmail.
2. Compose a new message. Copy and paste the language from [On the Rise Survey Template](#) into the body of the email. The text is also available as an appendix in this document.
3. Add the email signature “On the Rise.”
4. Name the template “OTR Monthly Survey” and save it. Select **More options**, point to **Templates**, choose **Save draft as template**, then select **Save as new template**.

Task 4

It’s a new month and Anthony is getting ready to launch the initiative. He asks you to prepare an email, insert the “OTR Monthly Survey” template, and apply the “On the Rise Vendors and Suppliers” contact label as the “To:” recipient.

Anthony also has a few additional requirements. He asks you to include company partner owner, Thomas Omar, as the “Cc:” recipient. He also wants you to include a shareable link to the “On the Rise Monthly Newsletter,” available in Google Drive. Make sure the link permissions are set to “View Only.”

Once you’re done, send the email. Then go to your Inbox and reply to any messages that you have received from others in your group.

Complete the following steps:

1. Compose a new email using the “OTR Monthly Survey” template that you created. Select **More options**, point to **Templates**, and select the name of your template to insert.
2. Apply the “On the Rise Vendors and Suppliers” contact label as the “To:” recipient.
3. Add Thomas Omar as a “Cc:” recipient. For course purposes, use your own email for Thomas.

Add a shareable link to the On the Rise Monthly Newsletter. For this step, you share a file that you own. Click the link ([On the Rise Monthly Newsletter](#)) and make a copy of the file when prompted.

4. In your email message, choose **Insert files using Drive**. Locate and insert your copy of the newsletter from either on the “My Drive” or “Recent” tabs.
5. Send the message and when prompted, check that the link permissions are set to “View” only.
6. Check your Inbox and reply to any message that you receive from other group members.

Task 5

Anthony begins to receive many responses from vendors and suppliers. As the emails all have the same subject, messages are being grouped in a single conversation thread, known as conversation view. You suggest that Anthony may prefer a chronological view of his messages and show him how this view changes the appearance of his messages. Anthony tells you he prefers conversation view, so you change it back.

Change views to show Anthony both chronological and conversation views.

Complete the following steps:

1. Find the conversation thread containing messages from your group members.
2. Open your Gmail “Quick settings” panel, then scroll and disable “Conversation view.” Notice how this action affects the messages from your group members.
3. Turn conversation view back on.

Task 6

Anthony wants to easily organize every message he receives. He’s also worried that certain messages might be going directly to Spam.

Help Anthony create a Gmail label called “On the Rise Vendors and Suppliers.” Then, assign all recent messages to that label.

Next, check Anthony’s Spam folder. If you find legitimate messages, mark them “Not Spam.”

Complete the following steps:

1. Create a new Gmail label. Choose **More** in the label list and scroll to select **Create new label**. Name the label “On the Rise Vendors and Suppliers.”
2. Select the messages you received from your group members and assign them to the label.
3. Check **Spam** for legitimate messages. If you find any, mark them **Not spam**.

Task 7

Anthony often receives messages from On the Rise partner owner Thomas Omar. These messages are always important and Anthony wants them easily accessible.

Search for a message from Thomas. You suggest marking messages from Thomas Omar as important. You also offer to apply a filter so all his future messages are automatically marked as important too.

Complete the following steps:

1. Check that **Importance markers > Show markers** is enabled in your Inbox settings.
2. Search for a message from Thomas Omar. For course purposes, use your own email as the email for Thomas Omar, and search for the message with the title “Supplier Survey Initiative”.
3. Open the message and confirm that the message is marked as **Important**.
4. Create a filter for messages from Thomas (your own email). Select **More**, then choose **Filter messages like these**. Enable **Always mark as important** and apply the filter to

any matching conversations.

Task 8

In his email, Thomas asks Anthony if he would share some of his survey findings next Wednesday during the On the Rise weekly Leadership Meeting on Google Meet. Anthony agrees and tells you he is preparing a Google Slide deck next Monday.

To help Anthony stay organized, you offer to create a task for him in Gmail. Create a task for next Monday and name it “Prepare Google slide deck with survey findings.”

Complete the following steps:

1. Create a task in your Gmail for next Monday, 9am.
2. Name your task “Prepare Google slide deck with survey findings.”
3. Make sure the task appears in Google Calendar. Tip: If you cannot see the task, ensure that “Tasks” is selected beneath “My calendars” in the left hand panel.

Task 9

Anthony tells you that in two weeks he is out of office Monday to Friday. He knows he has limited email access. You offer to set up an automatic out-of-office notification. Set one up with the information that he has provided you.

1. Set up a Vacation responder notification as follows:
 - a. Begin two weeks from now, Monday 9am through Friday 5pm.
 - b. Enter “Out of office” as the subject.
 - c. Add the response text.

Thank you for your email. I am presently out of office with limited access to email. For inquiries, please contact the Product Distribution and Operations team at 616-888-8888.

I am back in the office next week and will promptly respond to your email.

Thank you for your understanding.

IMPORTANT: Once you have completed the task, do not enable or save the Vacation responder.

Case wrap-up

Anthony presents the survey feedback at the weekly On the Rise Leadership Team Google Meet and partner owners, Seroja Malone and Thomas Omar, are very impressed. The feedback is useful, as it allows the team to identify numerous areas for improvement. They praise the initiative and look forward to Anthony's next report.

Anthony thanks you for helping him set up his Gmail account. He now feels confident that he can send his monthly survey emails without too much effort. In fact, he tells you that he plans to use the features you have shown him to simplify many of his other On the Rise communications. He also plans to better organize his Inbox.